

William Thissell

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EDUCATION

University of Virginia, School of Engineering and Applied Science

Charlottesville, VA

B.S. Aerospace Engineering

August 2025, May 2028

GPA: 3.83

Clubs: UVA Rocketry, Fixed Income & Derivatives, and Catholic Hoos

RELEVANT PROJECTS

International Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC) - UVA Rocketry Sub-Team Lead

September 2026 - Present

- Instructed a sub-team to design a fuel injector subsystem for a hybrid rocket engine within the R&D subdivision
- Cross-coordinated with the bulkhead and valve sub teams to ensure proper integration
- Used CAD software to construct a 3D model of the fuel injector to meet a desired flow coefficient
- Applied Computational Fluid Dynamics (CFD) software to understand the fluid flow for the model

Autonomous Landing & Perching, Hybrid Drone - Mechanical & Aerospace Team Lead

May 2026 - Present

- Worked with a small team of UVA Engineers to design the drone, specify direction, and project constraints
- Calculated realistic drag, lift, and thrust forces to determine design selections based on quantitative factors
- Focused mainly on CAD for the drone body, airfoils, tail perching mechanism, and electronic housing
- Employed CFD software to ascertain the coefficient of drag for the drone and located areas for improvement

Algorithmic Futures Market Trading System

May 2026 - September 2026

- Engineered a 20K-line Python platform that trades futures markets, evaluating 45 strategies across tens of thousands of simulated fills, with a TypeScript/Node.js execution gateway
- Developed a statistical evaluation that systematically retired several negative-EV strategies before risking capital
- Used AI-driven development in Claude Code orchestrating multi-agent code audits, developed and used original skills, subagent systems, and iterative strategy design with LLM agents

International Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC) - UVA Air Brakes Team

August 2025 - May 2026

- Helped to design an air brakes subsystem for precise apogee on a subteam
- Designed in Solidworks parts used in the airbrakes
- Manufactured carbon fiber flaps for the airbrakes system
- Assembled overall air brakes system and integration into the rocket

WORK EXPERIENCE

South Block (Local Smoothie Vendor) , Team Captain, Arlington, VA

Spring 2024 - Summer 2025

- Achieved two promotions within four months (from Team Member to Team Captain), gaining recognition for strong performance and leadership capability
- Oversaw shift operations and managed employees to ensure efficient workflow and product quality
- Trained several new team members while resolving customer issues

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Scouting America, Eagle Scout

Spring 2017 - Summer 2025

- Commanded a troop of 25-50 members as Senior Patrol Leader, overseeing all meetings and activities
- Guided a 12-member crew, as Crew Leader, on a 10-day trek across Philmont Scout Ranch
- Executed troop activities and led meetings as an elected youth leader for years
- Earned around 30 merit badges

AWARDS & HONORS

Eagle Scout

Achieved August 18, 2025

First Robotics Competition World Championship Competitor

Spring 2024

SKILLS

Certifications: Certified SOLIDWORKS Associate, PWC Management Consulting Simulation

Technical: Claude Code, Python, Java, MATLAB, AutoCAD, FEA, VS Code, Arduino Uno, MS Office